

Péter Balázs Polgár

PRODUCT DESIGN LEADER



I'm a system-minded design leader with 15+ years shaping complex B2B products, from SaaS to enterprise open-source. I build coherence into portfolios, the discovery that keeps it grounded, and the teams that sustain it. Increasingly I build it as working systems rather than documents, so teams and their agents work from the same foundation.

✉ polgarpeterbalazs@gmail.com

📍 Copenhagen, Denmark

🌐 peterbalazspolgar

🌐 polgarp.com

Experience

Lead Experience Designer @Canonical

Feb 2024 - Now

Canonical is an enterprise open-source company, maker of Ubuntu.

- Leading design for **the next iteration of Ubuntu Pro**, bringing 7 services into one experience: directing 4 designers, aligning 6+ product teams
- Driving product coherence at scale by contributing **layout patterns** to the design system, the category between components and journeys that holds an experience together across services
- Designed **the archetype system**, an agentic pipeline with human gates that keeps user descriptions current and sourced, now the commercial organisation's shared vocabulary
- Rebuilt the model behind **the Ubuntu Pro pricing page** to describe a conditional, modular offering: ~10% conversion lift, A/B tested
- Leading the team's **AI practice** by example: coding the prototypes the specs come out of, building the internal tooling designers use, and coaching those with no technical background into their first coded prototypes

Lead Product Designer @Krisp

Sep 2021 - Jan 2023

Krisp is an AI-powered noise cancellation and meeting assistant startup.

- Created **a vision prototype** through a four-week iterative discovery sprint that gave leadership confidence to execute a major strategic product pivot
- Established a rapid-iteration design process from discovery to delivery that became the organisation-wide standard for product development
- Scaled **user research practice** by coaching team members and introducing new methods, embedding continuous research into product decisions

Senior UX Manager @Trustpilot

Nov 2018 - Sep 2021

Trustpilot is a consumer review platform scaleup, IPO-d in 2021.

- Led **designers and researchers across 7 product teams** (~50-60 stakeholders), driving UX strategy for Trustpilot's B2B platform through to its 2021 IPO

Side projects

9am26 newsletter

My regular newsletter on product design leadership covering team building, design practices, and scaling design organisations.

Playground

Tinkering with AI and agentic tools to build small apps and experiments, a habit from my CS days. I explore ideas and technologies by making things.

Teaching and mentoring

University lecturer, course instructor, meetup speaker, and long-term mentor to designers, I'm committed to developing the next generation of design practitioners.

Education

Computer Science PhD (2013)

Eötvös University, Budapest (paused)

IT Education MSc (2011)

Eötvös University, Budapest

Computer Science MSc (2007)

Eötvös University, Budapest

- Headed an **information architecture redesign** achieving ~20% increase in intended user flows; significantly easier onboarding, to a foundation remaining in use 5+ years later
- Introduced a design maturity evaluation to create a **data-driven team strategy**, shifting the team from reactive to proactive and improving retention and cross-org decision-making
- Grew research impact with an embedded model across 20+ teams

Head of UX @Emarsys

Aug 2015 - Oct 2018

Emarsys is a marketing cloud platform, acquired by SAP in 2020.

- **Built a UX team from 2 to 16 designers and researchers** in 2 years, achieving 95%+ retention, with two subsequent heads of UX promoted from within
- Created and implemented a **design process from discovery to delivery**, establishing the UX practice and cross-functional collaboration across the organisation
- Shipped design system, email editor, campaign manager, and automation products, **unifying UX across the platform portfolio**
- Developed the **design org's structure, hiring practices**, and career ladder, fostering growth and retention of top talent

User Experience Researcher @Prezi

Nov 2011 - Aug 2015

Prezi is a canvas-based presentation startup.

- Drove **UX research in cross-functional product teams** for the presentation editor, collaboration features, and mobile apps, partnering with PMs, engineers, and data analysts
- Delivered key insights through qualitative and quantitative methods, directly informing product innovation and design decisions

Usability Engineer @B.Braun

Apr 2009 - Oct 2011

B.Braun is a medical technology company.

Conducted usability engineering for dialysis device software (chronic and acute care), ensuring IEC 62366 compliance and risk management protocol adherence